- welcome to present. abt. GFA
- discuss leading question "The Good Friday Agreement - Sustainable Peace or Temporary Solution?
- researching this quest. hope to discover strengths and weaknesses of GFA
- while also looking for reforms to improve situa. in NI
- partic. focus will lie mainly on GFA and developm. leading upto it
- ensures that we stay in area historical analysis rather than get to political
- to understand GFA have to look at BG of conflic in NI which alex is gon get startd with

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- British Army eventually deemed the ultimate enemy by nationalist community
- in this picture you can see people walking past british soldier, normal part of day2day life during troubles
- lead to formation of provisional irish republican army (ira) emerged as self-acclaimed "defenders of the nationalist cause" and proved to be one of the most import. paramils of troubles
- ira was (still is) decentralized paramilitary organization, taking part in street fights in NI and later coordinated terrorist attacks in england
- werent only nationalist paramlils formed, but also unionist:
- like Ulster Volunteer Force (UVF) and Ulster Defence Association (UDA)
- structues differed, uda had active membership structure, and IRA decentralized cell-based structure, like modern terrorist organization
- with founding of these groups, violence started to spiral out of control

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- government actually tried to adress some of issues of nationalist protesters, with one man one vote -> anyone would have one vote, no matter how many properties owned
- when violence still escalated, "peace walls", a network of 34km long walls, separating unionist and nationalist neighbourhoods, were built in an effort to stop further escalation
- on 30th of jan, 1972, british soldiers opened fire on catholic civil rights protesters, leading to death of 14 unarmed civilians -> sparked huge recruitment in provisional ira

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- escalating violence caused more and more people to look for peaceful solution, leading first to the sunningdale agreement in 1973 and the anglo-irish agreement in 1985
- both agreements failed, mainly because unionist felt they got taken away too much power/influence at once

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- after a lot of diplomatic efforts, this lead to 35-page long peace treaty named "the good friday agreement" being signed on 10th of April 1998

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